

Ricardo Manuel da Encarnação dos Santos

Location: Lisbon Metropolitan Area, Portugal
Email: ricardo.encarnacao.santos@gmail.com
LinkedIn: [linkedin.com/in/ricardoencarnacaosantos/](https://www.linkedin.com/in/ricardoencarnacaosantos/)
Mobile: Available upon request



Personal Summary

Senior Software Engineer with deep expertise in C#, ASP.NET Core, and Python, specializing in cross-platform backend services, distributed systems, and real-time telephony APIs.

Production AI/ML Experience: Track record of architecting scalable, multi-tenant Kubernetes services to train, deploy, and integrate NLP/deep learning models into live enterprise systems.

Cloud-Native Operations & Ownership: End-to-end expertise in building resilient cloud-native ecosystems on Kubernetes, featuring robust observability (OpenTelemetry, Prometheus, Grafana), automated CI/CD pipelines, and multi-cloud/on-prem deployments.

Professional Experience

Senior Software Engineer

Enghouse Interactive



Feb 2022 - Present | Lisbon, Portugal (Remote, Full-time)

- **Served as lead developer** for a cross-platform UCaaS (Unified Communications as a Service) backend service, guiding the technical implementation of a unified API that bridges multiple telephony platforms across Linux, Windows, Kubernetes, and on-premises environments.
- **Engineered robust server-side applications** using C#, ASP.NET Core, Entity Framework Core, PostgreSQL, and Python within a geographically distributed engineering team.
- **Extended telephony API with generative AI** (Gemini) capabilities, enabling the creation and management of autonomous call center agents with native tool and function-calling support for agentic workflows.
- **Integrated enterprise observability** by embedding OpenTelemetry collectors to export traces, logs, and metrics into a Prometheus and Grafana stack, reducing system troubleshooting time.
- **Implemented CI pipelines** using Jenkins and Bitbucket to automate building, testing, and exporting new releases.

Senior Software Developer

Enghouse Interactive



Jan 2021 - Jan 2022 | Lisbon, Portugal (Remote, Full-time)

- **Developed a web-based, low-code IVR flow designer** using ASP.NET/C# and React/Redux, enabling non-technical users to build complex inbound logic.
- **Integrated with a Natural Language Processing (NLP) engine**, incorporating third-party services (Microsoft LUIS) to detect the intent of customers when calling the IVR.

Core Skills & Technologies

Languages

- C#
- Python
- SQL
- Java
- TypeScript

Frameworks

- .NET / ASP.NET Core
- Entity Framework Core
- Windows Forms

Cloud & DevOps

- Docker
- Kubernetes
- Git / GitLab / Bitbucket
- Jenkins
- Azure ML
- Google Cloud
- Apache Kafka

Databases

- PostgreSQL
- MongoDB
- SQL Server

Observability

- OpenTelemetry
- Prometheus
- Grafana

Architecture

- REST APIs
- Microservices
- Event-driven architecture

Engineering Practices

- Agile / Scrum
- AI-assisted development (*GitHub Copilot*)

Languages

- Portuguese: Native

AI Engineer & Researcher

Altitude Software

May 2015 - Jan 2021 | Lisbon, Portugal (Hybrid, Full-time)



- **English:** Professional Working Proficiency (B2)

- **Designed scalable, multi-tenant Kubernetes microservices** using Python and Azure ML HyperDrive to automatically train and deploy neural network models with zero manual intervention.
- **Built an autonomous live chat recommendation engine** that, using machine learning models trained from transcripts, delivered predictive, context-aware suggestions to live agents.
- **Executed end-to-end AI research for predictive dialing**, researching and implementing Deep RL algorithms (DDPG, RDPG, Recurrent Q-Learning) in Python, and adapting a Java simulation platform (JaamSim) to rigorously test and validate performance.

Software Developer

Altitude Software

Jun 1997 - Apr 2015 | Lisbon, Portugal (On-site, Full-time)



- **Designed and developed uAgent Windows**, Altitude's flag-ship Windows desktop client, supporting high-concurrency voice, email, and live-chat agent interactions.
- **Architected .NET APIs and a layout editor** enabling Professional Services to build third-party integrations, embedded controls, and tailored workflow automation.
- **Implemented a high-performance call routing engine** in collaboration with Alcatel-Lucent, delivering complex, real-time call distribution logic for enterprise telephony systems.

Junior Web Developer

Megamedia

Oct 1996 - May 1997 | Lisbon, Portugal (On-site, Full-time)



Developed web design elements and client-facing interfaces for an early enterprise online banking platform (Santander-Totta).

Education

Post graduation, Advanced Management Program for Executives

Católica Lisbon School of Business and Economics | 2001 - 2002



Licentiate Degree in Information Systems and Computer Engineering

Instituto Superior Técnico (University of Lisbon) | 1991 - 1996



- **Specialization:** Information Systems and Databases | **Grade: 15.3**
- **Final Project:** Designed and built a 3D Virtual Desktop application managing Windows files and applications in an interactive 3D environment.
- **Leadership:** Member of the Board of Directors, IST Student's Union (1995 - 1996).

Additional Training

Machine Learning Coursera / Stanford Online (Andrew Ng) | 2018

Stanford | ONLINE

Keras: Deep Learning in Python Udemy | 2017

Machine Learning A-Z: Hands-On Python & R In Data Science Udemy | 2017

Complete Python Bootcamp Udemy | 2017

Usability in Practice (Methodologies) Nielsen Norman Group | 2007